

Tomas Valincius, LHP, Mississippi State

2026 Stats: 3.50 ERA/1.075 WHIP/97.2 IP/134 K/20 BB/6.7 K:BB

6-2, 225

Metrics

SI: 94.7/11 IVB/-16.7 HB/-6.07 IVB/5.8 relH/5.9 ext/29.1 AA/42.4% zone/53.4% usage/2290 rpm

CT: 87.8/6.5 IVB/0.1 HB/-6.41 VAA/28.8 AA/38.1% zone/1.4% usage/2600 rpm

SL: 86.4/1.2 IVB/7.9 HB/-7.6 VAA/29.3 AA/32.3% zone/33.9% usage/2780 rpm

CH: 86.6/4.9 IVB/-13.9 HB/-6.88 VAA/23.2% zone/11.4% usage/1920 rpm

Write-up

Valincius is one of the more polished left-handed starters in the 2027 class, combining a durable frame with above-average strike throwing and a two-pitch foundation that consistently misses bats. The Lithuanian southpaw attacks with a heavy sinker-slider combination that works to both sides of the plate, allowing him to dominate right-handed hitters while remaining effective against lefties. His ability to pound the strike zone without sacrificing swing-and-miss is reflected in his 134 strikeouts against just 20 walks across nearly 100 innings. There is little projection left physically, but the present arsenal, command, and workload all point toward a dependable professional starter with mid-rotation potential.

The SI is the engine of the repertoire. Averaging nearly 95 mph with heavy arm-side movement approaching 17 inches and enough ride to avoid becoming overly flat, it creates one of the better power sinker profiles among collegiate left-handers. The velocity allows the pitch to overpower hitters even when thrown inside the strike zone, while the movement consistently produces uncomfortable contact and weak ground balls. Valincius shows confidence attacking both edges, particularly jamming right-handed hitters and running the ball beneath left-handed barrels. Because of the velocity and movement combination, hitters rarely square the pitch up even when they anticipate it. Continued refinement elevating above the hands occasionally could create even more swing-and-miss, but the present pitch already projects comfortably above average. 60/65 pitch

The SL is the clear put-away offering and pairs exceptionally well with the sinker. Thrown in the mid-80s with tight late depth and enough horizontal movement to separate from the fastball, it tunnels effectively before disappearing beneath barrels. The pitch works equally well as a chase offering against right-handed hitters and a back-foot weapon against lefties, giving Valencius confidence to throw it in virtually any count. The high spin rate supports the late finish, and he consistently demonstrated the feel for landing it early before expanding with two strikes. The combination of velocity, shape, and command gives the slider legitimate plus potential. 55/60+ pitch

The CH quietly gives him another quality weapon against opposite-handed hitters. Thrown with excellent velocity separation off the sinker while maintaining late fading action, it creates a distinctly different movement profile than the slider despite sitting at a similar velocity. The pitch is used primarily against right-handed hitters to disrupt timing and keep them from sitting on hard glove-side action. While it remains his third offering, the shape and command suggest it can continue developing into an above-average pitch as he gains confidence throwing it more frequently. 50/55 pitch

The CT is used sparingly and functions more as a wrinkle than a featured part of the arsenal. It offers a shorter glove-side look that bridges the gap between the sinker and slider but is rarely necessary given how effective the primary three pitches already are. Unless its usage expands, it projects as an occasional show-me offering rather than a major contributor to the profile. 40/45 pitch